CLASS-13

TNPSC GROUP-II/IIA

PRELIMINARY EXAM (2025)

GENERAL ENGLISH

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"TO SUCCEED IN YOUR MISSION,

YOU MUST HAVE SINGLE-MINDED DEVOTION TO YOUR GOAL."

- DR. A.P.J. ABDUL KALAM

UPDATED SYLLABUS

UNITS	TOPICS	NO. OF QUESTIONS
I	GRAMMAR	25 QUESTIONS
II	VOCABULARY	15 QUESTIONS
III	WRITING SKILLS	10 QUESTIONS
IV	TECHNICAL TERMS	10 QUESTIONS
V	READING COMPREHENSION	20 QUESTIONS
VI	TRANSLATION	5 QUESTIONS
VII	LITERARY WORKS (SSLC STANDARD)	15 QUESTIONS

UNIT VII: LITERARY WORKS (15 QUESTIONS)

(SSLC STANDARD)

Prose: His First Flight – Liam O' Flaherty; The Night the Ghost Got In – James Grover Thurber; Empowered Women Navigating the World; The Attic – Satyajit Ray; Tech Bloomers; The Last Lesson – Alphonse Daudet; The Dying Detective - Arthur Canon Doyle; Learning The Game - Sachin Ramesh Tendulkar; I Can't Climb Trees Anymore – Ruskin Bond; Old Man River – Dorothy Deming (Drama); Seventeen Oranges – Bill Naughton; Water – The Elixir of Life – Sir C.V. Raman; From Zero to Infinity – Biography of Srinivasa Ramanujan; A Birthday Letter – Jawaharlal Nehru; The Nose Jewel C. Rajagopalachari; Hobby – Turns A Successful Career; Sir Isaac Newton – The Ingenious Scientist – Nathaniel Hawthorne; My Reminiscence – Rabindranath Tagore; Sea Turtles – Sheker Dattatri; When the Trees Walked – Ruskin Bond; A Visitor from Distant Lands; Sports Stars – Mithali Dorai Raj; The Last Stone Carver – Sigrun Srivastav; Eidgah – Munshi Premchand; The Wind on Haunted Hill – Ruskin Bond; A Prayer to the Teacher – Subroto Bagchi; The Tempest – Tales From Shakespeare; A Hunter Turned Naturalist – Jim Corbett; The Cat and the Painkiller (An Extract from the Adventures of Tom Sawyer) – Mark Twain.

A. **PROSE**
B. **BOOK INISIDE QUESTIONS**
C. **ABOUT THE AUTHOR**
D. **SUMMARY**
E. **GLOSSARY**

PROSE AND AUTHORS		
S.NO	**PROSE**	**AUTHORS**
1.	His First Flight	Liam O' Flaherty
2.	The Night the Ghost Got In	James Grover Thurber
3.	Empowered Women Navigating the World	-
4.	The Attic	Satyajit Ray
5.	Tech Bloomers	-
6.	The Last Lesson	Alphonse Daudet
7.	The Dying Detective	Arthur Canon Doyle
8.	Learning The Game	Sachin Ramesh Tendulkar
9.	I Can't Climb Trees Anymore	Ruskin Bond
10.	Old Man River	Dorothy Deming (Drama)
11.	Seventeen Oranges	Bill Naughton
12.	Water – The Elixir of Life	Sir C.V. Raman
13.	From Zero to Infinity	Biography of Srinivasa Ramanujan
14.	A Birthday Letter	Jawaharlal Nehru
15.	The Nose Jewel	C. Rajagopalachari
16.	Hobby Turns A Successful Career	-
17.	Sir Isaac Newton – The Ingenious Scientist	Nathaniel Hawthorne
18.	My Reminiscence	Rabindranath Tagore
19.	Sea Turtles	Sheker Dattatri
20.	When the Trees Walked	Ruskin Bond
21.	A Visitor from Distant Lands	-
22.	Sports Stars	Mithali Dorai Raj
23.	The Last Stone Carver	Sigrun Srivastav
24.	Eidgah	Munshi Premchand
25.	The Wind on Haunted Hill	Ruskin Bond
26.	A Prayer to the Teacher	Subroto Bagchi
27.	The Tempest	Tales From Shakespeare
28.	A Hunter Turned Naturalist	Jim Corbett
29.	The Cat and the Painkiller (An Extract from the Adventures of Tom Sawyer)	Mark Twain.

13. FROM ZERO TO INFINITY

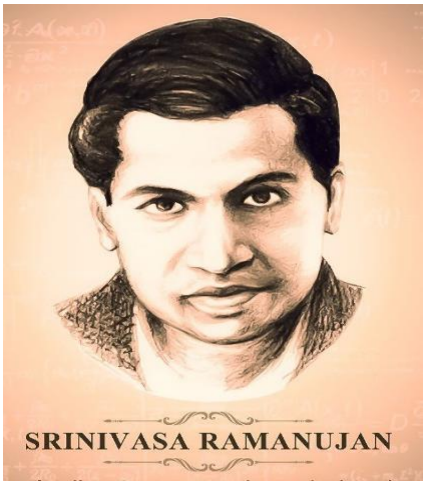
-BIOGRAPHY OR SRINIVASA RAMANUJAN

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Srinivasa Ramanujan was born on 22 December 1887 in Erode, Tamil Nadu.

He became a **child prodigy** at the age of 11.

He was a self-taught Indian mathematician who made extraordinary contributions to **number theory, infinite series, and mathematical analysis,** despite lacking formal training. His groundbreaking work was recognized when British mathematician **G.H. Hardy** invited him to **Cambridge University**, where Ramanujan collaborated on and published numerous papers. He was elected a **Fellow of the Royal Society in 1914** and is now considered one of the greatest mathematicians of all time.



The **arithmetic (Mathematics which involves counting)** class was in **progress (Continue, Happening at present)**. The teacher was solving questions on division. On the blackboard were drawn three bananas. "We have three bananas," the teacher said, "and we have three boys. Can you tell me how many each will get?" A **smart (Intelligent)** boy in the front row replied, "Each will get one." "Right," the teacher said. "Now, similarly, if 1,000 bananas are distributed among 1,000 boys, each will get one, isn't that so?" While the teacher was explaining, a boy sitting in one corner raised his hand and stood up.

The teacher stopped and waited for the boy to speak. "Sir," the boy asked, "If no banana is distributed among no one, will everyone still get one banana?" There was **a roar of laughter (A term used to show that one is laughing hard)** in the class. What a **silly (Foolish, Not having logic)** question to ask!

"Quiet!" the teacher said loudly and **thumped (To hit at something really hard)** the desk. "There's nothing to laugh at. I will just explain what he means to say. For the division of bananas, we divided three by three, saying that each boy will get one banana.

Similarly, we divided 1,000 by 1,000 to get one. What he is asking is that if zero banana is divided among zero, will each one get one? The answer is 'no'. Mathematically, each will get an infinite number of bananas!" Everyone laughed again. The boys understood the trick, arithmetic had played upon them. What they could not understand was why the teacher later **complimented (To appreciate someone for something good)**. the boy who had asked that **absurd (stupid and unreasonable, silly in a humorous way)** question.

The boy had asked a question that had taken mathematicians several centuries to answer. Some mathematicians claimed that zero divided by zero was zero. Others claimed it to be unity. It was the Indian mathematician Bhaskara who proved that it is **infinity (unlimited space, time, amount, a number large beyond any limit).** The boy who asked the **intriguing (very interesting because of being unusual or mysterious)** question was Srinivasa Ramanujan. Throughout his life, whether in his native Kumbakonam or Cambridge, he was always ahead of his mathematics teachers.

a) What was the reaction of the classmates to Ramanujan's question?

- There was a roar of laughter in the class when Ramanujan asked a question. The boys exclaimed that it was a silly question to ask.

b) What did the Indian mathematician Bhaskara prove?

- The Indian mathematician Bhaskara proved that zero divided by zero is infinity

Ramanujan was born in Erode in Tamil Nadu on December 22, 1887. His father was **a petty (In small scale) clerk (A low rank officer)** in a cloth shop. From early childhood it was evident that he was a **prodigy (a child who shows a great ability at a young age).** Senior students used to go to his **dingy (a dark and dirty place)** house to get their difficulties in mathematics solved.

At the age of 13, Ramanujan was lent a book on advanced trigonometry written by S.L. Loney. Not only did he master this rather difficult book but also began his own research. He came forth with many mathematical **theorems (A rule in mathematics that can prove itself to be true)** and formulae not given in the book, though they had been discovered much earlier by great mathematicians. The most **significant (Important)** turn came two years later when one of his senior friends showed him the book A **Synopsis (A gist or summary)** of Elementary Results in Pure Applied Mathematics, a collection of 4865 formulae and theorems without proof by G.S. Carr. For a boy of 16 the title itself must be frightening, but Ramanujan was **delighted (Happy)**. He took the book home and began to work on the problems given in it.

This book **triggered (To make something happen)** the mathematical genius in him. Mathematical ideas began to come in such a flood to his mind that he was not able to write all of them down. He used to do problems on loose sheets of paper or on a slate and **jot (To write quickly)** the results down in notebooks. Before he went abroad, he had filled three notebooks, which later became famous as Ramanujan's **Frayed (Loose, hanging about)** Notebooks.

c) Where did Ramanujan get S.L. Loney's book on Trigonometry?

- Ramanujan got Loney's "Trigonometry" book from a college library.

d) Where did Ramanujan do his mathematical problems?

- Ramanujan did his mathematical problems on loose sheets of paper or on a slate and jot the results down in note books.

Although Ramanujan secured a first class in Mathematics in the matriculation examination and was awarded the Subramanyan **Scholarship (A reward, mostly in the form of money)**, he failed twice in his first-year arts examination in college, as he neglected other subjects such as History, English and **Physiology (the branch of biology that deal with the normal functions of living organisms and their parts)**. This **disappointed (Not happy or dissatisfied)** his father. When he found the boy always scribbling numbers and not doing much else, he thought Ramanujan had gone mad.

Ramanujan began to look for a job. He had to find money not only for food but for papers as well to do his calculations. He needed about 2,000 sheets of paper every month. Ramanujan started using even **scraps of paper (Small pieces of paper)** he found lying on the streets. Sometimes he used a red pen to write over what was written in blue ink on the piece of paper he had picked up.

Unkempt (not neat or cared for) and **uncouth (behaving in an unpleasant way)**, he would visit offices, showing everyone his frayed notebooks and telling them that he knew mathematics and could do a clerical job. But no one could understand what was written in the notebooks and his applications for

jobs were turned down. Luckily for him, he at last found someone who was impressed by his notebooks. He was the Director of Madras **Port (A place where ships are docked)** Trust, Francis Spring, and he gave Ramanujan a clerical job on a monthly salary of ₹25.

Later some teachers and educationists interested in Mathematics initiated a move to provide Ramanujan with a research **fellowship (A scholarship for conducting research in a subject).** On May 1, 1913, the University of Madras granted him a fellowship of ₹75 a month, though he had no qualifying degree.

e) What were the subjects neglected by Ramanujan in college?

➢ The subjects neglected by Ramanujan in college were History, English, and Physiology.

f) Which University granted him a fellowship of ₹75 a month?

➢ The University of Madras granted him a fellowship? 75 of a month.

A few months earlier, Ramanujan had sent a letter to the great mathematician G. H. Hardy, of Cambridge University, in which he set out 120 theorems and formulae. Among them was what is known as the Reimann Series, a topic in the definite integral of **Calculus (A branch of mathematics that deals with rates of change, for example the speed of a falling object).** But Ramanujan was ignorant of the work of the German mathematician, George F. Riemann, who had earlier arrived at the series, a rare achievement. Also included was Ramanujan's **conjecture (an opinion or conclusion formed on the basis of incomplete information)** about the kind of equations called "modular". Pierre Deligne subsequently proved this conjecture to be correct. It did not take long for Hardy and his **colleague (A person with whom one works with)**, J.E. Littlewood, to realise that they had discovered a rare mathematical genius.

They made arrangements for Ramanujan's passage and stay at Cambridge University. On March 17, 1914, he sailed for Britain. Ramanujan found himself a **stranger (An unknown person)** at Cambridge. The cold was hard to bear and being a vegetarian, he had to cook his own food. However, he continued his research in Mathematics with determination.

g) What did Ramanujan send to G.H. Hardy?

➢ Ramanujan sent a letter to G.H. Hardy in which he set out 120 theorems and formulae.

h) Who discovered a rare mathematical genius in Ramanujan?

➢ G.H. Hardy and his colleague, J.E. Little wood discovered a rare mathematical genius in Ramanujan.

In the company of Hardy and Littlewood, he could forget much of the hardship he had to endure. In Ramanujan, Hardy found an **unsystematic (Not organized)** mathematician, similar to one who knows the Pythagorus theorem but does not know what a congruent triangle means. Several **discrepancies (an illogical or surprising lack of compatibility or similarity between two or more facts)** in his research could be attributed to his lack of formal education. Ramanujan played with numbers, as a child would with a toy. It was sheer genius that led him to mathematical "truths".

The task of proving them, so important in Science, he left to lesser **mortals (Normal people who have to die someday).** Ramanujan was elected, Fellow of the Royal Society on February 28, 1918. He was the youngest Indian to receive this **distinguished (used to describe a person, respected and admired for excellence)** fellowship. In October that year he became the first Indian to be elected Fellow of Trinity College, Cambridge.

His achievements at Cambridge include the Hardy-Ramanujan-Littlewood circle method in number theory, Roger-Ramanujan's identities in partition of integers, a long list of the highest composite numbers, besides work on the number theory and the algebra of inequalities. In algebra his work on continued fractions is considered to be equal in importance to that of great mathematicians like Leonard Euler and Jacobi.

While Ramanujan continued his research work, **Tuberculosis** **(A disease that affects the lungs)**, then an incurable disease, was **devouring** **(destructively consuming)** him. Ramanujan was sent back to India and when he **disembarked** **(to leave a ship, aircraft, etc. after a journey)**, his friends found him pale, exhausted and **emaciated** **(very thin and weak, usually because of illness or extreme hunger).**

To forget the **agonizing** **(causing extreme physical or mental pain)** pain, he continued to play with numbers even on his death bed. Besides being a mathematician, Ramanujan was an astrologer of repute and a good speaker. He used to give lectures on subjects like "God, Zero and Infinity".

SUMMARY

- This lesson 'From Zero to Infinity' is a biography of Srinivasa Ramanujan. He was an Indian Mathematician, who lived during British rule in India. His knowledge of Mathematics was extraordinary. One day, when the arithmetic class was in progress, his teacher was solving questions on division. When the teacher asked the students if there were three students and three bananas, how many bananas each student would get, a smart boy replied that each one would get one banana.
- Then he proceeded to ask if 1000 bananas were distributed among 1000 boys, would each one get one banana? Ramanujan stood up and asked his teacher, if no banana is distributed among no one, would everyone still get one banana? All the other students laughed at this silly question. But the teacher understood his question and explained to the students what he had asked.
- It was if zero banana is divided among zero, would each one get one? The answer would be 'no' Mathematically, each would get an infinite number of bananas. The boy had asked a question that had taken mathematicians several centuries to answer. Ramanujan was born in Erode in Tamilnadu on December 22, 1887. From early childhood, it was evident that he was a prodigy.
- Senior students used to get his assistance in solving math problems. At the age of 13, he began his own research on Trigonometry. The book "Synopsis of Elementary Results in Pure Applied Mathematics" by George Shoobridge Carr triggered the genius in Ramanujan. He used to do problems on loose sheets and enter the results in notebooks which are now famous as "Ramanujan's Frayed Notebooks".
- Although Ramanujan secured a first-class in Mathematics in the matriculation examination and was awarded the Subramanyan Scholarship, he failed twice in his first-year arts examination in college as he neglected other subjects such as History, English and Physiology. He searched for a job for food and papers to do calculations, The Director of Madras Port Trust gave a clerical job to Ramanujan on a monthly salary of Rupees 25.

- Ramanujan sent a letter to the great Mathematician G. H. Hardy of Cambridge University, in which he set out 120 theorems and formulae, which included the Reimann Series. Hardy and his colleague Littlewood realized that they had discovered a rare mathematical genius. They invited him to Britain. Despite the cold weather and food, Ramanujan continued his research with determination in the company of Hardy and Littlewood.
- Hardy found an unsystematic mathematician in Ramanujan due to his lack of formal education. Ramanujan's achievements include the Hardy-Ramanujan-Littlewood circle method in number theory. As Ramanujan was suffering from Tuberculosis, he was sent back to India. Even on his death bed, he continued to play with numbers, so that he could forget his agonising pain. Ramanujan was also an astrologer and a good speaker. He gave lectures on subjects like "God, Zero and Infinity".

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
Arithmetic	Mathematics which involves counting
Progress	Continue, Happening at present
Interactive	People communicating and working together
Etched	Made a mark
ppt	Power-point presentations
Constable	A lower rank police official
Smart	Intelligent
Silly	Foolish, Not having logic
Roar of laughter	A term used to show that one is laughing hard
Pause	Stop for a brief moment
Contradict	To mean the Opposite
Thumped	To hit at something really hard
Complimented	To appreciate someone for something good
Absurd	Having no logic
Intriguing	To stir interest
Infinity	Unlimited
Probability	Chances
Petty	In small scale
Prodigy	A highly talented child
Dingy	Dirty and dark
Theorems	A rule in mathematics that can prove itself to be true
Moderate	Average
Inclined roof	Slanted roof
Significant	Important
Synopsis	A gist or summary
Delighted	Happy
Triggered	To make something happen

Jot	To write quickly
Frayed	Loose, hanging about
Scholarship	A reward, mostly in the form of money
Disappointed	Not happy or dissatisfied
Physiology	The study of living things
Scraps of paper	Small pieces of paper
Unkempt	Not well cared for
Uncouth	Not clean; Socially unacceptable
Port	A place where ships are docked
Fellowship	A scholarship for conducting research in a subject
Clerk	A low rank officer
Conjecture	To guess about something without real proof or evidence
Calculus	A branch of mathematics that deals with rates of change, for example the speed of a falling object.
Colleague	A person with whom one works with
Consecutive	Happening one after the other
Determined	Firmly believing that one would succeed
Stranger	An unknown person
Unsystematic	Not organised
Discrepancies	The difference between things
Conservative	Very traditional, sticking to old rules
Tropical	A country that is in the middle of the globe
Mortals	Normal people who have to die someday
Distinguished	Very respected
Tuberculosis	A disease that affects the lungs
Emaciated	Extremely thin
Agonising	Painful

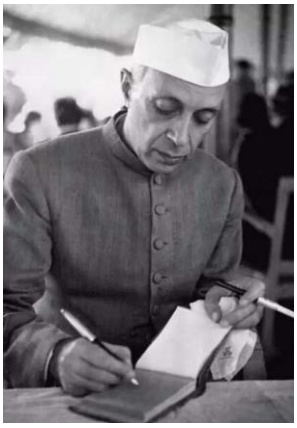
14. A BIRTHDAY LETTER
- JAWAHARLAL NEHRU

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

- Jawaharlal Nehru (**14 November 1889** – 27 May 1964) was the **first Prime Minister of India** and a central figure in Indian politics before and after independence.
- He emerged as an eminent leader of the Indian independence movement under the **tutelage of Mahatma Gandhi** and served India as Prime Minister from its establishment as an independent nation in 1947 until his **death in 1964.**



- He is considered to be the ar**chitect of the modern Indian nation-state:** a sovereign, socialist, secular, and democratic republic.
- He was also known as '**Pandit Nehru**' while many Indian children knew him as '**Uncle Nehru**'.
- He worked as the Prime Minister of India for seventeen years and received **the Bharat Ratna award in 1955.**
- **Some of his works** are,
  - The Discovery of India
  - Glimpses of World History
  - Toward Freedom



It was the summer of 1928, when Jawaharlal Nehru began writing **letters (A written message from one person to another, usually put in an envelope and sent by post)** to his young daughter, Indira, who was in Mussoorie at that time. In his letters, he speaks to his daughter on a wide range of topics, including languages, trade, history, geography, science, epics and evolution. When Indira was about to turn 13 in 1930, Nehru started sending her more detailed letters. These letters contained his understanding of the world which he wanted to further impart to his daughter.



Even while he was in **prison (A building where criminals are forced to live as a punishment)**, he wanted to make sure that his child is not devoid of her father's teachings. Over the next four years, Nehru continuously wrote to his daughter from prison and his words are still inspiring. The letters written by Nehru from the various prisons in British India to his daughter Indira, were published in 1942 as a book called "Glimpses of World History". It is a collection 196 letters on world history.

NOW READ THE LETTER FROM JAWAHARLAL NEHRU TO HIS DAUGHTER INDIRA.

Central Prison,
Naini October 26, 1930

My dear Indira,

On your birthday you have been in the habit of receiving **presents (A materialistic object that can be given as a gift on a special occasion like a birthday or marriage)** and good wishes. Good wishes you will still have in full measure, but what present can I send you from Naini Prison? My presents cannot be very material or solid.

They can be of the mind and spirit. Things that even the high walls of prison cannot stop. You know sweetheart, how I dislike sermonising and doling out good **advice (An opinion that someone offers you about what you should do or how you should act in a particular situation)**. I have always thought that the best way to find out what is right and what is not right, what should be done and what should not be done, is not by giving a **sermon (ceremony in which a priest gives a talk on a religious or moral Subject)**, but by talking and discussing, and out **of discussion(The action or process of talking about something to reach a decision or to exchange ideas)** sometimes a little bit of truth comes out.

I have liked my talks with you and we have discussed many things, but the world is wide and beyond our world lie other wonderful and **mysterious (Difficult or impossible to understand, explain, or identify)** worlds. None of us need ever be bored or **imagine (To form or have a mental picture or idea of something)** that we have learned everything worth learning and become very wise.

But what am I to do then? A letter can hardly take the place of a talk; at best it is a one-sided affair. Imagine that I have made a **suggestion (An idea or plan put forward for consideration)** to you for you to think over, as if we really were having a talk. In history we read of great periods in the life of nations, of great men and women.

Do you **remember (To be able to bring back a piece of information into your mind, or to keep a piece of information in your memory)** how **fascinated (extremely attracted)** you were when you first read the story of Joan of Arc, and how your **ambition (A strong desire to do or achieve something)** was to be something like her? Ordinary men and women are not usually **heroic (Having the characteristics of a hero or heroine; admirably brave or determined).** They think of their bread and butter, of their children, of their **household (A group of people, often a family, who live together)** **worries (Feel or cause to feel anxious or troubled about actual or potential problems)** and the like. But a time comes when a whole people become interested in a great cause.

Then history helps even simple, ordinary men and women to become heroes. Great leaders have something in them which **inspires (Fill someone with the urge or ability to do or feel something, especially to do something creative)** a whole people and makes them do great **deeds (a brave or noble act).** In India a great leader, full of love for all who suffer and eager to help them, has inspired our people to great actions and noble **sacrifice (To give up something that is valuable to you to help another person)**. He has helped to make the **starving (suffering or dying from hunger),** the poor and the **oppressed (governed in an unfair and cruel way and prevented from having opportunities and freedom)** free and happy. Bapuji is in prison, but the magic of his message has stolen the hearts of India's millions.

Gandhiji

Men and women, and even little children, come out of their little shells and become India's **soldiers (A person who serves in an army)** of freedom. In India today we are making history, and you and I are fortunate to see this happening before our eyes and to take some part ourselves in this great drama.

If we are to be India's soldiers, we have to respect India's **honour (High respect; great esteem),** and that honour is a **sacred (considered to be holy and deserving respect)** trust. It is no easy matter to decide what is right and what is not. One little test I shall ask you to apply whenever you are in **doubt (A feeling of uncertainty or lack of conviction)**.

Never do anything in secret or anything that you would wish to hide. For the desire to hide anything means that you are afraid, and fear is a bad thing and **unworthy (Not deserving respect or attention)** of you. Be brave, and all the rest follows. You know that in our great Freedom Movement, under Bapuji's **leadership (The action of leading a group of people or an organization),** there is no room for **secrecy (The action of keeping something secret or the state of being kept secret)** or hiding.

We have nothing to hide. We are not afraid of what we do or what we say. We work in the sun and in the light. Even so in our private lives let us make friends with the sun and work in the light and do nothing secretly and if you do so, my dear, you will grow up a child of the light, unafraid and **serene (peaceful and calm)** and **unruffled (not nervous or worried, usually despite a difficult situation),** whatever may happen.

I have written a very long letter to you. And yet there is so much I would like to tell you. How can a letter contain it? Good-bye, little one, and may you grow up into a brave soldier in India's service. With all my love and good wishes.

Your loving father,
JAWAHARLAL NEHRU

1. **From which prison did Nehru write this letter?**
   - Nehru wrote the letter from Central Prison, Naini, in Uttar Pradesh.
2. **Did Nehru send any presents to Indira?**
   - Nehru did not send any present to Indira.
3. **Which historical character inspired young Indira?**
   - The historical character Joan of Arc inspired young Indira.
4. **What helps the ordinary men and women to become heroes?**
   - History helps the ordinary men and women to become heroes.
5. **Who is addressed as 'Bapuji'?**
   - Mahatma Gandhiji is addressed as Bapuji.
6. What should the soldiers of India respect?
   - The soldiers of India should respect India's honour.

SUMMARY

- The letters, written by Nehru from the various prisons in British India to his daughter Indira, were published in 1942 as a book called "Glimpses of World History". It is a collection of 196 letters on World History. This extract is about a letter, written by Jawaharlal Nehru to his daughter Indira, when he was in the Central Prison at Naini. As he was not able to send a gift to Indira on her birthday, he wrote to her. Though presents are appreciated, letters can equally be cherished as gifts. Nehru disliked giving sermons or advice because he believed that only by talking and discussing. sometimes

a little bit of truth comes out. The two factors that make ordinary men heroes are full faith in a great cause and learning the history of the world. Mahatma Gandhi inspired millions of people to fight for freedom. He has helped to make the starving, the poor and the oppressed free and happy. If we are to be India's soldiers, we have to respect India's honour which is a sacred trust. He advises Indira not to do anything in secret or wish to hide anything. She should always stand bold and be brave always. Only then, will she grow up to be a child of the light, unafraid, calm and peaceful. He concludes finally by wishing her to grow up into a brave soldier in India's service.

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
Prison	A building where criminals are forced to live as a punishment
Mysterious	Difficult or impossible to understand, explain, or identify
Imagine	To form or have a mental picture or idea of something
Discussion	The action or process of talking about something to reach a decision or to exchange ideas
Sermon	A long talk in which someone advises other people how they should behave to be better people
Advice	An opinion that someone offers you about what you should do or how you should act in a particular situation
Present	A materialistic object that can be given as a gift on a special occasion like a birthday or marriage
Suggestion	An idea or plan put forward for consideration
Letter	A written message from one person to another, usually put in an envelope and sent by post
Remember	To be able to bring back a piece of information into your mind, or to keep a piece of information in your memory
Fascinated	Strongly attracted and interested
Ambition	A strong desire to do or achieve something
Household	A group of people, often a family, who live together
Worries	Feel or cause to feel anxious or troubled about actual or potential problems
Heroic	Having the characteristics of a hero or heroine; admirably brave or determined
Inspires	Fill someone with the urge or ability to do or feel something, especially to do something creative
Oppressed	Governed unfairly and cruelly and prevented from having opportunities and freedom
Starving	Suffering or dying from hunger
Sacrifice	To give up something that is valuable to you to help another person
Honour	High respect; great esteem
Soldier	A person who serves in an army
Doubt	A feeling of uncertainty or lack of conviction
Unworthy	Not deserving respect or attention
Leadership	The action of leading a group of people or an organisation
Secrecy	The action of keeping something secret or the state of being kept secret
Unruffled	Not disordered or disarranged

15. THE NOSE JEWEL

- C. RAJAGOPALACHARI

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



- **Chakravarti Rajagopalachari (1878-1972)** informally called Rajaji, was an Indian politician, independence activist, lawyer, writer, historian and statesman.
- Rajagopalachari was born in the village of **Thorapalli** in the Krishnagiri district. Rajagopalachari was the **last Governor-General of India,** as India soon became a Republic in 1950.
- Furthermore, he was the **first Indian-born governor- general,** since before him the posts were held by British nationals.
- He also served as leader of the Indian National Congress, Premier of the Madras Presidency, Governor of West Bengal, Minister for Home Affairs of the Indian Union and Chief Minister of Madras state. He was one of the **first recipients of India's highest civilian award, the Bharat Ratna.**

Ramayya was a simple man living in the town. He lived with his wife in a nice house made of tiled roof. He was not rich but he could take care of his family. Two sparrows built a nest in a nice spot on the roof of Ramayya's house.

The mother bird laid her eggs in it. “My dear," began the male sparrow. “And what do you want now?" asked his wife. "Why does the lady of this house always **quarrel (A heated argument or disagreement, typically about a trivial issue and between people who are usually on good term)** with her husband?" "How am I to know?" said the female bird. “Let us mind our own business." "You are always **self-centred (concerned with the self),**" said the male sparrow and added, "Should we not help this poor Ramayya?" The female sparrow said with **disdain(feeling of contempt or scorn),** "Let me see what help you can do for him. Please do not talk about what does not **concern (A matter of interest or importance to someone)** us.



See that the cat does not come near our nest. That would be enough for you and me." Somewhere in the **muckheap (a pile of dung, soil or refuse)** lay a diamond nosejewel. The male bird picked it up and came to the nest with the shining **stud (A small piece of metal jewellery that is put through a part of your body such as your ear or nose)** in his beak and said the female bird: "Look! Do you like this? The female bird replied, "What am I to do with diamond nose studs or with ear-rings? Find some **grub (food)**; the young ones are hungry."



The bird dropped the diamond stud on the floor and went out in search of little worms for the young ones. Ramayya's wife noticed the jewel as she was sweeping the floor. She picked it up with **delight (A heated argument or disagreement, typically about a trivial issue and between people who are usually on good term).** and wore it. Ramayya questioned her angrily, "From where did you get this diamond-stud?" "I found it lying here yesterday and took it.

That is all." "We should go and handover it to the village **magistrate (a judicial officer with limited authority to administer and enforce the law).**

Tomorrow if the police should come and search our house, it will be a **disgrace (the state of being dishonoured, or covered with same)** to us." In the neighourhood of Meenakshi Ammal, the talk went thus: "I forgot and left it in the bathroom. Kuppayi, the maid-servant must have swept it out. She is very careless and **ignorant (Lacking knowledge or awareness in general).**" The mother, Meenakshi Ammal, **consoled (comforted (someone)** in the time of grief or Disappointment) her little girl saying, "Let us search and find it. Don't tell father yet. He would go into a **rage (Very strong and uncontrolled anger)** if he knew that you had lost the diamond nose-stud."

- A bird's eye takes up about 50 percent of its head; our eyes take up about 5 percent of our head.
- To be comparable to a bird's eyes, our eyes would have to be the size of baseballs.

"What is the secret you are whispering?" asked Ramanatham. The loss of the jewel had to be admitted. Soon the whole village knew about it. The maid-servant Kuppayi was **suspected (believed to be a cause or at fault)** to have stolen it by everyone. The police came and searched her hut, but could find nothing. Ramayya's heart was in a **flutter (to flap or wave quickly but irregularly).** Ramayya's wife put the stud away in her box. She soon developed a severe fever and was **confined (restricted, kept in a limited space or area)** to bed. No one thought of searching their house.



The he-sparrow said, "Look at the fun, my dear, the lady of this house is scared and is down with fever." "Nice fun indeed!" said the shesparrow. "The poor woman is in a **panic (frightened).** The fever may be the end of her." "And a good thing too," said the **cruel (merciless or heartless)** male sparrow. "It is all your doing you brought and threw it here and **tempted (To make someone want to have or do something, especially something that is unnecessary or wrong).** her," said the female bird. The male bird answered **gravely (in a grave or serious manner),** "Did I tell her to steal the thing? This is bound to happen when humans are **greedy (Having a strong and impure desire for wealth, especially when it is more than what one need).**"





"Rightly said, we should never be greedy for what belongs to others". "Come, let us go now and bring some worms for the young ones." And the two flew out. Ramayya and his wife spend the rest of life in fear of being caught. The diamond **nose-jewel(A jewel or ornament worn in or above a person's nose).** may still be with them, but the fear of getting caught was ever lasting.

SUMMARY

- Ramayya was a simple man, who lived in a town. His house was made of tiled roofs. He lived with his wife. He was not rich. But he took good care of his family. On the roof of his house, two sparrows built a nest. The mother-bird laid her eggs in it. The male-bird wanted to help Ramayya, as he noticed Ramayya's wife always quarrelling with him.But the female bird advised her male bird not to bother about others. But to mind their own business.One day, the male-bird found a diamond nose-jewel in a heap. When he showed it to his wife, she replied that it was of no use to her. So, she asked him to find some food for the young ones. The bird dropped the diamond stud on the floor and went out in search of food.Ramayya's wife noticed the jewel as she was sweeping the floor. She picked it with delight and wore it. Her husband shouted at her and told her that they should go and deliver it to the magistrate. But his wife wouldn't want to part with it. This nose-stud belonged to their neighbour, Meenakshi Ammal's daughter. She forgot and left it in the bathroom. Kuppayi, their servant woman would have swept it out. Meenakshi Ammal con-soled her daughter. She also advised her not to inform her father Ramanatham about the lost stud. He would become very angry. But her husband Ramanatham and the whole village knew about it. The maid-servant was suspected to have stolen it. The police came and searched for the jewel in her hut. But they could not find it.Ramayya's wife put the stud away in her box. She soon developed a severe fever and was always in her bed. The two birds witnessed all this and thought that "we should never be greedy for what belongs to others." Ramayya and his wife spent the rest of their lives in fear of being caught.

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
Quarrel	A heated argument or disagreement, typically about a trivial issue and between people who are usually on good term.
Self-centred	To think only about oneself and one's affairs/needs.
Disdain	Mockery mixed with anger.
Concern	A matter of interest or importance to someone.
Muck-heap	A pile or a collection of waste/garbage.
Nose-jewel	A jewel or ornament worn in or above a person's nose.
Stud	A small piece of metal jewellery that is put through a part of your body such as your ear or nose.
Grub	An insect in the stage when it has just come out of its egg, like a short, fat worm; food.
Delight	A heated argument or disagreement, typically about a trivial issue and between people who are usually on good term.
Get hold of	To obtain or find something.

Magistrate	A person who acts as a judge in a law court that deals with crimes that are less serious.
Disgrace	To make people stop respecting you or your family, team, etc. by doing something very bad.
Ignorant	Lacking knowledge or awareness in general.
Console	To comfort someone in the time of grief, disappointment.
Rage	Very strong and uncontrolled anger.
Suspect	To think that someone has committed a crime or done something wrong.
Flutter	(Heart or stomach flutter) To feel slightly uncomfortable because you are excited or nervous.
Confined	Restricted, kept in a limited space or area.
Panic	To suddenly feel so worried or frightened that you cannot think or behave calmly or reasonably.
Cruel	Extremely unkind and heartless, and intentionally causing pain.
Tempt	To make someone want to have or do something, especially something that is unnecessary or wrong.
Gravely	In a grave or serious manner.
Greedy	Having a strong and impure desire for wealth, especially when it is more than what one need.

16. HOBBY - TURNS A SUCCESSFUL CAREER

SECTION-I

Once there was a boy named Mani. He was studying at the school in his village. He found it difficult to read and write. His grandfather noticed it and helped him by reading bedtime stories. Gradually, he started reading on his own. Now, he not only enjoyed reading but also has started writing his own stories. Let us read an essay written by Mani.



Hobbies are the activities that we do in our **spare (extra)** time.

Hobbies are **unique (distinctive / uncommon)** to people. Some like gardening, a few like photography, many have book reading as their hobby. While other hobbies are swimming, collecting stamps, playing video games, and many more. People have hobbies not only to pass their free time but also to do something useful. Hobbies help people learn new things, relax after a day of tiring work and to **energise (give energy)** their body and mind. Same is the case with me. I love writing, so it is my hobby.

- "Whatever you like to do, make it a hobby." -**Warren Buffet**

Writing is a unique hobby because most people don't want to **exhaust (tire out)** themselves in their spare time. Many feel that writing is tough, but I do not think so. I feel writing is like painting our voice. When I get free time, I pick a pen and a notebook and start painting my ideas in words. I write stories, poems and sometimes, about my feelings. My mind relaxes when I pour my thoughts as words. So, writing energises me. When I write things, my imagination is at its best. I imagine a world with magic and magicians, where I can fly, and birds can talk.

Writing helps me completely immerse myself into that world! Sometimes, I sit with small children and entertain them with these stories of mine. The happiness of their faces makes me to write more and better. Although writing is just a hobby for me, yet it is very beneficial. It opens my mind to think beyond the little things with a broader mind. It makes me more **passionate (intense/ heartfelt)** about my life. It makes me learn new things and enjoy every moment of my life.

- "Writing is easy. All you have to do is cross out the wrong words." -**Mark Twain**

My hobby helped me in school too. When I started writing things, I was unable to describe them **accurately (exactly)**. With time, my experiences helped me think of new ideas and this made me a good writer. Now, I look out for things, which I was not able to see before. Hence, I can describe things better in my stories. I feel no problem with writing English essays or stories as it is my hobby.

- The former Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, Mr C.N. Annadurai, had the hobbies of reading and writing.
- He wrote many books, stories, plays, thought-provoking articles and cine dialogues which have contributed to reformation of society as we know it today!

To become a better writer, I spend time on learning how to write in different forms like **fiction (imaginative writing)** and non-fiction. It is important to always learn and improve our hobbies. Who knows? One day I could be a writer like R.K. Narayan!

SECTION-II

Ajay Kumar Garg, is a very talented young artist. He lives in Jaipur, India. His childhood was going on well, until he suffered an injury at the age of three.

Ajay was treated, but that treatment left him permanently hearing impaired. His parents tried several hospitals to cure his **impairment (disability)**, but it didn't cure him. His father, once bought him a paint set to play. Ajay started to paint happily. He painted on the walls, floors etc. He looked happy, while using the paint set that was gifted to him. Soon, Ajay's father realised that Ajay was talented in painting. When Ajay was five years old, a court artist of Dholpur (Rajasthan), Shri Sua Lal saw his painting and was very impressed with his work. He then took Ajay and started training him. After completing his education, Ajay tried tailoring but, that didn't make him happy so he went back to painting.

He became an apprentice of Asha Devi. She taught Ajay the old and dying technique of 'Traditional Indian **Miniature (very small of its kind)** Painting'. He mastered the technique of preparing colors and brushes and gained knowledge of the paintings. Soon he became an **accomplished (fulfilled)** artist in the miniature style. He uses a **magnifying (enhancing)** glass and a single haired brush for miniature paintings that depict Indian culture. Ajay is gifted in the practice of creating images on a grain of rice.



Ajay **exhibited (show or reveal)** his work and sold 144 out of the 150 paintings displayed. He continued to show his work throughout India, the United States and the United Kingdom. In 2004, Ajay was awarded a national award of accomplishment from the Indian President, Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam. Apart from painting, Ajay is also very actively involved in the welfare of people with hearing impairment in India and has been the executive member of the 'Deaf & Dumb Association' in Rajasthan.

He also gives free training to hearing impaired children in Jaipur as well as children in an orphanage in Gandhi Nagar, Jaipur. One of Ajay's current goals is to **revitalize (re-energise)** the dying art of traditional miniature Indian paintings. Ajay's life shows us that we can turn our hobby or passion into a successful career, if we are ready to learn and develop our skills.

SUMMARY (SECTION – I)

A boy named Mani had difficulty in reading and writing. His grandfather noticed this and helped him by reading bedtime stories. Gradually, Mani started reading on his own. After some days, he also started writing his own stories. In this section, he wrote an essay on hobbies. Hobbies are the activities done during our free time. They are special to people.

Some people like gardening, a few like photography and many have book reading as their hobby. Hobbies help people to learn new things, relax after a tiring day and energise our body and mind. Mani's hobby was writing. Though many people feel writing is tough, he felt 'writing' was like 'painting our voice. When he wrote things, he imagined a world with magic and magicians.

Writing opened his mind to think beyond the little things with a broader mind. It made him learn new things and enjoy every moment of his life. His hobby of writing helped him in school too. He could describe things better in his stories. He had no problem in writing English essays or stories, as it was his hobby. Thus it is important to always learn and improve our hobbies.

SUMMARY (SECTION – II)

Ajay Kumar Garg, a very talented young artist lived in Jaipur, India. He suffered an injury at the age of three and became hearing impaired. His parents tried many hospitals to cure his disability. But it was useless. Ajay used to paint on the walls and floors. Realizing his interest in painting, a court artist of Dholpur, Shri Sua Lal started educating him in painting. After completing his education, Ajay became an apprentice of Asha Devi, who taught him the 'Miniature Painting.

Soon, Ajay became an 'accomplished artist' in the miniature style. He was gifted in the practice of creating images on a grain of rice. Ajay exhibited his work and sold 144 out of 150 paintings displayed in the exhibition. His work became famous throughout India, the United States and the United Kingdom. In 2004, he was awarded a national award of accomplishment from the then Indian President, Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.

Ajay also involved in the welfare of people with hearing impairment and gave them free training. He has been the executive member of 'Deaf and Dumb' Association in Rajasthan. One of Ajay's current goals is to re-energize the dying art of traditional miniature Indian paintings. Thus, Ajay's life shows us that we can turn our hobby into a successful career, if we are ready to learn and develop our skills.

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
unique (adj)	distinctive / uncommon
exhaust (v)	tire out
energises (v)	give energy
passionate (adj)	intense/ heartfelt
accurately (adv)	exactly
fiction (n)	imaginative writing

spare (adj)	Extra
impairment (n)	disability
miniature (adj)	very small of its kind
accomplished (adj)	fulfilled
magnifying (adj)	enhancing
exhibited (v)	show or reveal
revitalise (v)	re-energise

17. SIR ISSAC NEWTON - THE INGENIOUS SCIENTIST

- NATHANIEL HAWTHORNE

On Christmas-day, in the year 1642, Isaac Newton was born at the small village of Woolsthorpe in England. Little did his mother think, when she beheld her new-born babe, that he was **destined (preordained, bound)** to explain many matters which had been a mystery ever since the creation of the world. Isaac's father being dead, Mrs. Newton was married again to a clergyman, and went to reside at North Witham. Isaac was left to the care of his good old grandmother, who was very kind to him, and sent him to school. In his early years, Isaac was chiefly **remarkable (worthy of attention; striking)** for his **ingenuity (the ability to invent things / creativity)** in all mechanical occupations.

He had a set of little tools, and saws of various sizes, manufactured by himself. With the aid of these, Isaac **contrived (created / invented)** to make many curious articles, at which he worked with so much skill, that he seemed to have been born with a saw or chisel in his hand. The neighbors looked with vast admiration at the things which Isaac manufactured.



And his old grandmother, I suppose, was never **weary (feeling or showing extreme tiredness)** of talking about him. "He'll make a **capital (excellent)** workman, one of these days," she would probably say. "No fear but what Isaac will do well in the world, and be a rich man before he dies." Some of his friends, no doubt, advised Isaac's grandmother to **apprentice (works for someone to learn skill)** him to a clockmaker; for, besides his mechanical skill, the boy seemed to have a taste for mathematics, which would be very useful to him in that profession. And then, in due time, Isaac would set up for himself, and would manufacture curious clocks, like those that contain sets of dancing figures, which issue from the dial-plate when the hour is struck; or like those, where a ship sails across the face of the clock, and is seen tossing up and down on the waves, as often as the pendulum vibrates.

Indeed, there was some ground for supposing that Isaac would devote himself to the manufacture of clocks; since he had already made one, of a kind which nobody had ever heard of before. It was set a-going, not by wheels and weights, like other clocks, but by the dropping of water. This was an object of great wonderment to all the people in the neighborhood; and it must be confessed that there are few boys, or men either, who could contrive to tell what o'clock it is, by means of a bowl of water. Besides the water-clock, Isaac made a sun-dial. Thus his grandmother was never at a loss to know the hour; for the water-clock would tell it in the shade, and the dial in the sunshine.

The sun-dial is said to be still in existence at Woolsthorpe, on the corner of the house where Isaac dwelt. Isaac possessed a wonderful **faculty** **(an inherent mental or physical power)** of **acquiring** **(getting knowledge or skill)** knowledge by the simplest means. For instance, what method do you suppose he took, to find out the strength of the wind?. He jumped against the wind; and by the length of his jump, he could calculate the force of a gentle breeze, a brisk **gale** **(very strong wind)**, or a **tempest** **(violent windy storm)**. Thus, even in his boyish sports, he was continually searching out the secrets of philosophy. Not far from his grandmother's residence there was a windmill, which operated on a new plan. Isaac was in the habit of going thither frequently, and would spend whole hours in examining its various parts.

While the mill was at rest, he **pried** **(investigated)** into its internal machinery. When its broad sails were set in motion by the wind, he watched the process by which the mill-stones were made to revolve, and crush the grain that was put into the **hopper** **(funnel shaped bins for feeding grains into mills)**. After gaining a thorough knowledge of its construction, he was observed to be unusually busy with his tools.

It was not long before his grandmother, and all the neighborhood, knew what Isaac had been about. He had constructed a model of the windmill. Though not so large, I suppose as one of the box-traps which boys set to catch squirrels, yet every part of the mill and its machinery was complete. Its little sails were neatly made of linen, and **whirled** **(moved rapidly round and round)** round very swiftly when the mill was placed in a **draught** **(a current of cool air in a room or other confined space)** of air. Even a puff of wind from Isaac's mouth, or from a pair of **bellows** **(a device with an air bag that emits a stream of air when squeezed together)**, was sufficient to set the sails in motion. And what was most curious if a handful of grains of wheat were put into the little hopper, they would soon be converted into snow white flour. Isaac's playmates were **enchanted** **(charmed, filled with delight)** with his new windmill. They thought that nothing so pretty, and so wonderful, had ever been seen in the whole world. " But, Isaac," said one of them, "you have forgotten one thing that belongs to a mill." "What is that?" asked Isaac; for he supposed, that, from the roof of the mill to its foundation, he had forgotten nothing. "Why, where is the miller?" said his friend.



"That is true! —I must look out for one," said Isaac; and he set himself to consider how the deficiency should be supplied. He might easily have made the miniature figure of a man; but then it would not have

been able to move about, and perform the duties of a miller. But perhaps some two-legged millers are quite as dishonest as this small **quadruped** **(four-legged animal)**.

As Isaac grew older, it was found that he had far more important matters in his mind than the manufacture of toys, like the little windmill. All day long, if left to himself, he was either absorbed in thought, or engaged in some book of mathematics, or natural philosophy. At night, I think it probable, he looked up with **reverential** **(with a deep respect to)** curiosity to the stars, and wondered whether they were worlds, like our own,—and how great was their distance from the earth,-and what was the power that kept them in their courses.

Perhaps, even so early in life, Isaac Newton felt a **presentiment** **(an intuitive feeling about the future)** that he should be able, hereafter, to answer all these questions. When Isaac was fourteen years old, his mother's second husband being now dead, she wished her son leave school, and assist her in managing the farm at Wools Thorpe. For a year or two, therefore, he tried to turn his attention to farming. But his mind was so bent on becoming a **scholar** **(a specialist in a specific branch of study),** that his mother sent him back to school, and afterwards to the University of Cambridge.

He was the first that found out the nature of Light; for, before his day, nobody could tell what the sunshine was composed of until then. You remember, I suppose, the story of an apple's falling on his head, which lead him to discover the force of gravitation and which keeps the heavenly bodies in their courses. When he had once got hold of this idea, he never permitted his mind to rest, until he had searched out all the laws, by which the planets are guided through the sky. This he did as thoroughly as if he had gone up among the stars, and tracked them in their orbits. As a boy, he had found out the mechanism of a windmill; and as a man he explained to his fellow-men the mechanism of the universe.

While researching he was **accustomed** **(usual, habitual)** to spend night after night in a **lofty** **(great height, tall)** tower, gazing at the heavenly bodies through a telescope. His mind was lifted far above the things of this world. He may be said, indeed, to have spent the greater part of his life in worlds that lie thousands and millions of miles away; for where the thoughts and the heart are, there is our true existence.

Newton lived to be a very old man, **renowned** **(famous, known or talked about)** thinker and was made a Member of Parliament, and received the honor of **knighthood** **(the title, rank, or status of a knight)** from the king. But he cared little for earthly fame and honors, and felt no pride in the vastness of his knowledge.

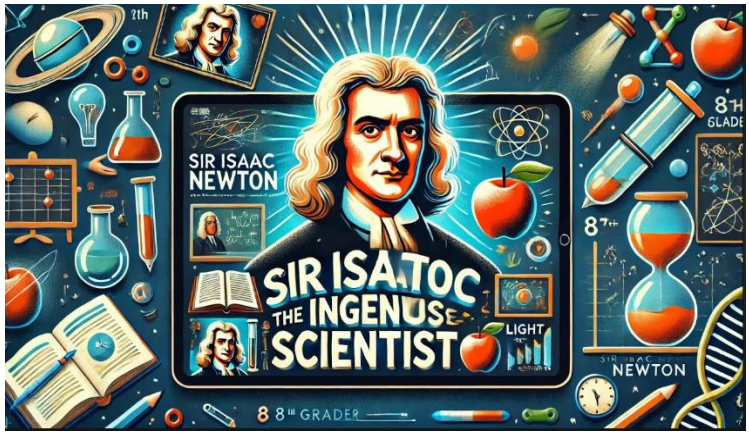
All that he had learned only made him feel how little he knew in comparison to what remained to be known. "I seem to myself like a child," he observed, "playing on the sea-shore, and picking up here and there a curious shell or a pretty pebble, while the boundless ocean of Truth lies undiscovered before me." At last, in 1727, when he was 85 years old, Sir Isaac Newton died, —or rather he **ceased** **(stopped)** to live on earth. We may be permitted to believe that he is still searching out the infinite wisdom and goodness

of the Creator, as **earnestly** **(with sincere and intense conviction),** and with even more success, than while his spirit animated a mortal body. He has left a fame behind him, which will be as **endurable** **(able to be endured; bearable)** as if his name were written in letters of light, formed by the stars upon the midnight sky.

- Wheels, our greatest invention… Man's greatest invention wheel is fundamental to transport, agriculture, industry and the world in which we live today.

"I love to hear about mechanical **contrivances** **(a clever device or object that has been invented for a particular purpose)**—such as the water-clock and the little windmill," remarked George. "I suppose if Sir Isaac Newton had only thought of it, he might have found out the steam-engine, and railroads, and all the other famous inventions that have come into use since his day."

"Very possibly he might," replied Mr. Temple; "and, no doubt, a great many people would think it more useful to manufacture steam-engines, than to search out the system of the universe. Other great astronomers, besides Newton, have been endowed with mechanical genius. There was David Rittenhouse, an American, —he made a perfect little water-mill, when he was only seven or eight years old. But this sort of ingenuity is but a mere **trifle** **(a thing of little value or importance)** in comparison with the other talents of such men."



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

- Nathaniel Hawthorne (July 4, 1804 – May 19, 1864) was an American novelist, dark romantic, and short story writer.
- His works often focus on history, morality, and religion. He was born in 1804 in Salem, Massachusetts, to Nathaniel Hathorne and the former Elizabeth Clarke Manning.
- The biography of Sir Isaac Newton was published in Nathaniel Hawthorne's, True Stories from History and Biography (1851).

SUMMARY (SECTION -I)

- Isaac Newton was born in 1642 in a village in England. He was brought up by his kind grandmother. During his school days, he was remarkable for his ingenuity. He invented curious articles with his tools. His neighbours and grandmother admired his inventions and believed he would be a capital workman in future. His friends wanted him to be an apprentice for a clockmaker.

- Newton was good in mechanical and maths skills. He made curious clocks like the dancing figures, the sailing ship as the pendulum vibrates and the clock that worked by the dropping of water. Newton also made a sun-dial which is still in his house at Woolsthorpe.
- He could acquire knowledge in simple ways. Like, to find the strength of the wind, he jumped against the wind and by the length of his jump, he calculated the force of the wind.
- Newton frequently went to the new windmill near his house and examined its parts and internal machines for many hours.When the windmill was working, he watched the process by which the mill-stones revolved and crushed the grains. Thus he learnt about the construction of the windmill and he made his own small windmill with available materials like box-traps, linen for sails. When this windmill was placed in the air, even a puff of wind from Newton's mouth made the windmill work and the handful of grains put into it turned to snow-white flour.

SUMMARY (SECTION -II)

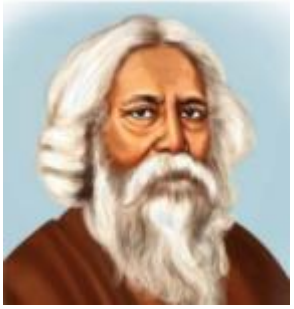
- Isaac Newton's playmates always admired his toys, particularly the windmills. But one of his friends said that he had forgotten something in the making of the windmill, when Isaac was sure that it lacked nothing. It lacked a miller so he used a quadruped (mouse). As Isaac grew older, he started thinking beyond making toys.
- He isolated himself, thought deeply, read some book of mathematics or philosophy and at nights he observed the stars. He asked himself many curious questions about the world of stars, their distance from earth, their orbits, hold force and so on.
- After fourteen years he helped his widow mother, but his mind was bent to become a scholar. So his mother sent him to the University of Cambridge. Isaac was the first to find the nature of Light. When an apple fell on his head, he discovered the force of gravitation. He tracked the orbits of the planets and stars on the sky.
- When he was doing his researches, he spent all nights on a tower, gazing the heavenly bodies through a telescope. His mind was above this world. He spent most of his life in the world that lie millions of miles away. Sir Isaac Newton died in 1727 when he was 85 years old.
- He was a Member of Parliament and received the honour of knighthood from the king. But he was not proud of his earthly fame or knowledge. His name is written in letters of light, formed by the stars in mid sky.Mr. George and Mr. Temple remark that if Isaac had lived longer, he would have found all the other inventions of today too.

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
destined	preordained, bound
remarkable	worthy of attention; striking
ingenuity	the quality of being clever, original, and inventive
contrived	deliberately created rather than arising naturally
weary	feeling or showing extreme tiredness
capital	excellent
apprentice	employ (someone) as a trainee to a skilled employer
faculty	an inherent mental or physical power
gale	very strong wind
tempest	violent windy storm
whirled	moved rapidly round and round
draught	a current of cool air in a room or other confined space
bellows	a device with an air bag that emits a stream of air when squeezed together
hoppers	funnel shaped bins for feeding grains into mills
enchanted	charmed, filled with delight
reverential	with a deep respect to
presentiment	an intuitive feeling about the future
quadruped	four-legged animal
scholar	a specialist in a specific branch of study
accustomed	usual, habitual
lofty	great height, tall
renowned	famous, known or talked about
knight	a man awarded a non-hereditary title in recognition of merit and entitled to use the honorific 'Sir' in front of his name
knighthood	the title, rank, or status of a knight
earnestly	with sincere and intense conviction
endurable	able to be endured; bearable
contrivance	a clever device or object that has been invented for a particular purpose
ceased	stopped
trifle	a thing of little value or importance

18. MY REMINISCENCE

- RABINDRANATH TAGORE

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



- Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941), **Nobel prize-winning Bengali poet**, author, philosopher, artist, and educator wrote "**Gitanjali" (1912).**
- "**My Reminiscences**" was written and published in his **fiftieth year**, shortly before he started on a trip to Europe and America for his failing health in 1912.
- It was in the course of this trip that he wrote for the first time in the English language for publication.

When I returned home from the outset of my second **voyage (a long journey involving travel by sea or in space)** to England, my brother Jyotirindra and sister-in-law were living in a river-side villa at Chandernagore, and there I went to stay with them. The Ganges again! Again those **ineffable (beyond expression in words, unspeakable)** days and nights, **languid (moving slowly)** with joy, sad with **longing (a yearning, intense desire),** attuned to the **plaintive (sounding sad)** **babbling (the continuous murmuring sound of flowing water)** of the river along the cool shade of its wooded banks.

This Bengal sky-full of light, this south breeze, this flow of the river, this right royal laziness, this broad leisure stretching from **horizon (the line at which the earth's surface and the sky appear to meet)** to horizon and from green earth to blue sky, all these were to me as food and drink to the hungry and thirsty. Here it felt indeed like home, and in these I recognised the **ministrations (the act of helping or caring)** of a Mother. That was not so very long ago, and yet time has **wrought (caused)** many changes.

Our little riverside nests, **clustering (forming a group)** under their surrounding greenery, have been replaced by mills which now, dragon-like, everywhere rear their hissing heads, **belching (to let air come up)** forth black smoke. In the midday glare of modern life even our hours of mental **siesta (an afternoon rest or nap)** have been narrowed down to the lowest limit, and **hydra-headed (having many facets or aspects)** **unrest (a state of dissatisfaction, disturbance, and agitation)** has invaded every department of life. Maybe, this is for the better, but I, for one, cannot account it wholly to the good. These lovely days of mine at the riverside passed by like so many dedicated lotus blossoms floating down the sacred stream. Some rainy afternoons I spent in a **veritable (more exciting)** **frenzy (a state of uncontrolled excitement or wild behaviour)**, singing away old Vaishnava songs to my own tunes, accompanying myself on a harmonium.

On other afternoons, we would drift along in a boat, my brother Jyotirindra accompanying my singing with his violin. And as, beginning with the Puravi, we went on varying the mode of our music with the declining day, we saw, on reaching the Behaga, the western sky close the doors of its factory of golden toys, and the moon on the east rise over the **fringe** **(an ornamental border of threads at the end of a cloth)** of trees.



Then we would row back to the landing steps of the villa and seat ourselves on a **quilt** **(a warm bed covering made of padding enclosed between layers of fabric)** spread on the terrace facing the river. By then a silvery peace rested on both land and water, hardly any boats were about, the fringe of trees on the bank was reduced to a deep shadow, and the moonlight **glimmered** **(shine faintly with a wavering light)** over the smooth flowing stream. The villa we were living in was known as 'Moran's Garden'.

A **flight** **(a series of steps)** of **stone-flagged** **(a flat stone, cut in regular rectangular or square shape and usually used for paving platforms)** steps led up from the water to a long, broad verandah which formed part of the house. The rooms were not regularly arranged, nor all on the same level, and some had to be reached by short flights of stairs. The big sitting room overlooking the landing steps had **stained glass** **(coloured glass used to form decorative designs)** windows with coloured pictures.

One of the pictures was of a swing hanging from a branch half-hidden in dense **foliage** **(plant leaves collectively)** , and in the **checkered** **(divided into an arrangement of squares of different colour)** light and shade of this **bower** **(a pleasant shady place under trees),** two persons were swinging; and there was another of a broad flight of steps leading into some castle-like palace, up and down which men and women in festive **garb** **(clothes)** were going and coming. When the light fell on the windows, these pictures shone wonderfully, seeming to fill the river-side atmosphere with holiday music. Some far-away long-forgotten **revelry** **(lively and noisy festivities)** seemed to be expressing itself in silent words of light; the love thrills of the swinging couple making alive with their eternal story the woodlands of the river bank.

The topmost room of the house was in a round tower with windows opening to every side. This I used as my room for writing poetry. Nothing could be seen from **thence** **(from a place or source previously mentioned)** save the tops of the surrounding trees, and the open sky. I was then busy with the Evening Songs and of this room I wrote: There, where in the breast of limitless space clouds are laid to sleep, I have built my house for **thee** **(old-fashioned term for "you")**, O **Poesy** **(poetry)**!

SUMMARY

- Tagore returned home from the outset of his second voyage to England. His brother Jyotirindra lived in a river-side villa at Chandernagore, in West Bengal. Tagore went there to stay with him. With a sad longing, Tagore recaptured his incredible days spent joyfully along the wooded banks of the river Ganges. The bright sky, breeze, flow of the river, its stretch from horizon to horizon, greenery, all were the food and drink for the hungry and thirsty soul of the author.
- The author noticed many changes when he visited the Ganges after a long time. The greenery had been replaced by huge noisy mills emitting smoke. This might be for good, but the author could not agree with it. The author spent his afternoons at the riverside singing songs, to his own tunes and playing the harmonium. Sometimes he sailed in the boat singing songs with his brother playing the violin, till the evening.
- At night Tagore sat on the terrace facing the river. He viewed the river reflecting the moonlight, dark trees bordering the river banks and a silver streak separating the land and water.
- Tagore described his villa, 'Moran's Garden. It had stone stairs leading to a broad verandah. The rooms were not on the same level and not regularly arranged. The big sitting room facing the landing steps had staired glass windows with coloured pictures.
- One picture had a swing hanging from a dense branch with a couple on it. The other picture had people walking on a staircase leading to a castle-like palace in grand dresses. When the light fell on the glass pictures, it made the scene alive.
- Tagore's room was in a round tower, on the top, with windows around viewing the treetops and sky. Tagore wrote his famous poem from this room.

GLOSSARY		
1.	ineffable	too great to be expressed or described in words
2.	languid	relaxed, lazy
3.	longing	a yearning, intense desire
4.	horizon	the line at which the earth's surface and the sky appear to meet
5.	ministrations	the provision of assistance or care
6.	wrought	made in a specified way
7.	belching	(especially of a chimney) send out large amounts of (smoke or flames)
8.	siesta	an afternoon rest or nap
9.	hydra-headed	having many facets or aspects
10.	unrest	a state of dissatisfaction, disturbance, and agitation
11.	voyage	a long journey involving travel by sea or in space
12.	babbling	the continuous murmuring sound of flowing water
13.	veritable	a word used for emphasis

14.	frenzy	a state of uncontrolled excitement or wild behaviour
15.	fringe	an ornamental border of threads at the end of a cloth
16.	quilt	a warm bed covering made of padding enclosed between layers of fabric
17.	glimmered	shine faintly with a wavering light
18.	stone-flagged	a flat stone, cut in regular rectangular or square shape and usually used for paving platforms
19.	flight	a series of steps
20.	stained glass	coloured glass used to form decorative designs
21.	foliage	plant leaves collectively
22.	checkered	divided into an arrangement of squares of different colour
23.	bower	a pleasant shady place under trees
24.	garb	clothing, especially of a distinctive or special kind
25.	revelry	lively and noisy festivities
26.	thence	from a place or source previously mentioned
27.	Poesy	poetry
28.	Thee	old-fashioned term for "you"

19. SEA TURTLES

- SHEKER DATTATRI

Most of us have seen a tortoise in a zoo or a reptile park. However, not many would have seen its **marine** **(found in the sea)** relative, the sea turtle. This is not surprising, since these reptiles spend almost their entire life in the sea. There are seven **species** **(group of animals with common features)** of marine or sea turtles in the world. Of them, five are found in India's **coastal** **(land by the edge of a sea)** waters:

1. the Olive Ridley,
2. the Hawksbill,
3. the Green Sea Turtle,
4. the Loggerhead and
5. the Leatherback.



Compared to most tortoises, sea turtles are huge. Even the smallest species, the Olive Ridley, weighs up to 35 kg when fully grown.

The largest of them all, the Leatherback, grows to a length of 2.2m and each could weigh as much as 700 kg! Sea turtles live their life entirely in the oceans. But they still have a connection with land – they must come ashore to lay eggs. Today, four of the sea turtle species mentioned above have become extremely rare in India. The Olive Ridleys, however, are still commonly seen nesting on sandy beaches all along our coasts.

ARRIBADA

- In most parts of the world, Olive Ridleys come ashore alone to lay their eggs.
- However, Odisha is one of the only three places in the world where a phenomenon known as 'mass nesting' or Arribada takes place.
- On certain nights during the nesting season, thousands of female turtles come ashore simultaneously to lay their eggs on particular beaches.



SECTION -II

TAKE TURNS AND READ THIS SECTION ALOUD. WORK IN PAIRS AND UNDERLINE THE NEW WORDS. FIND OUT THEIR MEANINGS FROM THE DICTIONARY.

Between the months of January and March, female Olive Ridleys come ashore at night to lay their eggs. This is quite a problem for them, as a turtle's front **flippers** **(broad, flat limbs used for swimming)** enable it to swim gracefully and effortlessly but are not very useful for moving on land. The turtle has to **haul** **(pull with force)** itself **laboriously** **(with great effort)** onto the beach. Then it chooses a spot

well away from the high-tide line. Here, it scoops out a nest **cavity** **(a hollow space)** 45 cm deep, into which it lays about 100 eggs.



Each egg is in the shape and size of a table tennis ball. Once all the eggs are laid, the turtle fills in the cavity, then it **camouflages** **(hide or disguise something)** the nest by tossing sand on it using its flippers. That done, it returns to the sea. The eggs are left to **incubate** **(hatch eggs using warmth)** under the warmth of the sun.

In many places around the world, local people follow the tracks of the turtle to its nest. They collect the eggs for eating. Jackals, domestic dogs and pigs too dig up and eat the eggs by following the scent left by the turtle. Those eggs that escape such people and **predators** **(animals that kill other animals for food)** hatch 45–60 days later. The hatchlings **slash** **(cut)** open the leathery eggshell with the help of a tiny 'egg-tooth'.

This is like a razor blade at the tip of a hatchling's **snout** **(pointed nose of an animal)** . When most of the eggs have hatched, the hatchlings push themselves upwards through the sand and **emerge** **(come out)** on the surface of the beach. From here they make a hurried dash to the sea.

- There is an interesting aspect of sea turtle biology. The temperature inside the egg determines the sex of the embryo while it is growing.
- When the eggs develop at 27 °C – 28 °C only male hatchlings are produced. At 30 °C only female hatchlings are produced. An equal mix of male and female hatchlings is produced only when the eggs incubate at precisely 29 °C – 30 °C.

SECTION - III

READ THIS SECTION IN PAIRS.

Many of these tiny hatchlings, which weigh less than 20 grams each, will not even reach the sea. They will fall prey to crabs or birds even before they reach the water. Most of those that do make it into the water will also be eaten by many predators in the sea within the first few days of their lives. In fact, scientists estimate that only one in every thousand hatchlings becomes an adult. It is perhaps to ensure that enough hatchlings **survive** **(continue to live)** to keep the species going that sea turtles lay so many eggs.

After many years of swimming in the open ocean, the female hatchlings that have become adults return to the same beach where they were born. They come there to lay their own eggs. How they manage to find the place after so many years in the sea is one of the many **mysteries** **(facts that are difficult to understand)** of these **fascinating** **(attracting greatly)** reptiles! Sea turtles are among the many wonderful creatures we share this planet with. They have survived natural dangers for millions of

years. But, sadly, human activities during the last few **decades** **(a period of ten years)** have put them in grave danger.



There are many factors that threaten their survival. People hunt them for their meat or collect their eggs. Sometimes they are accidentally trapped in the nests of motorboats. Problems like pollution, dumping of plastics into the ocean and construction activities on nesting beaches also hurt their survival. Only by systematically tackling these problems, and removing these threats, can we ensure that sea turtles will continue to exist in the years to come.

SHEKAR DATTATRI

- Shekar Dattatri writes popular articles on wildlife, conservation and film making. He has been interested in nature from childhood. He is an award-winning wildlife and conservation filmmaker.

SUMMARY - SECTION I

- This lesson is about Sea Turtles which are different from Tortoise that we see in a zoo or a reptile park. There are seven species of sea turtles -out of which five are seen in India – the Olive Ridley, the Hawksbill, the Green Sea Turtle, the Loggerhead, and the Leatherback. The turtles are huge and weigh between 35 kg and 700 kg.
- The largest sea turtle is the Leatherback which is 2.2m long and 700 kg in weight. Sea turtles come to the shore to lay their eggs. Except for Olive Ridleys, other species have become rare in India. Mass Nesting or Arribada is a phenomenon that occurs in Odisha and other two places in the world where Olive Ridleys come ashore alone to lay their eggs.

SUMMARY - SECTION II

- Between January and March, female Olive Ridleys come ashore and haul (pull with force) using their front flippers onto the beach. They choose a spot away from the high tide and dig 45 cm into which they lay their eggs. They lay about 100 eggs at one time. After covering the nest with sand it returns to the sea.
- The eggs are left to incubate under the sun. People collect these eggs for eating. Jackals, domestic dogs, and pigs eat the eggs. After escaping from the predators, the hatchlings (little ones) come out of the eggshell with the help of an egg-tooth. After they come out they make a dash into the sea.

SUMMARY - SECTION III

- Weighing less than 20 grams, many of these hatchlings fall prey to crabs or birds before they reach the sea. It is estimated that one in a thousand hatchlings become an adult. After swimming for years in the sea, the adult female returns to the same beach where they were born which is an unsolved mystery. Human activities have endangered the survival of sea turtles.
- Problems like pollution, the dumping of plastics into the ocean, and the construction activities on nesting beaches endanger their survival. We have to tackle these problems to save the sea turtles.

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
marine	found in the sea
species	group of animals with common features
coastal	land by the edge of a sea
flippers	broad, flat limbs used for swimming
predators	animals that kill other animals for food
haul	pull with force
slash	cut
laboriously	with great effort
snout	pointed nose of an animal
cavity	a hollow space
emerge	come out
camouflage	hide or disguise something
incubate	hatch eggs using warmth
survive	continue to live
mysteries	facts that are difficult to understand
fascinating	attracting greatly
decade	a period of ten years

CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWERS. YOU MAY CHOOSE MORE THAN ONE ANSWER IF NEEDED.

1) The _____ is a biological relative of tortoises.

   a. sea turtle b. fish c. reptile

2) In India's coastal waters we can see a species of _____.

   a. tortoises **b. sea turtles** c. dolphin

3) Sea turtles come to the shore to_____.

   a. visits their birth place **b. lay eggs** c. go back to sea

4) It is a problem for sea turtles to come ashore because _____.

   a. they find it difficult to walk on sand

   b. they don't know their way to the shore

   c. animals and people hunt them

5) A turtle's flippers help it to _____.

   a. swim b. dig a nest c. climb

6) A sea turtle camouflages its nest by tossing sand on it to _____.

   a. hide its eggs from predators

   b. incubate eggs in the warmth of the sun

   c. keep the hatchlings safe

FIND ANY FIVE WORDS RELATED TO SEA FROM THE TEXT (SECTIONS I & II).
WRITE THEM BELOW. THEN USE THE WORDS TO FRAME SENTENCES OF YOUR OWN.

eg: beach	We like to play in the sandy beach.
Swimming	I like swimming
Motorboat	We went on a motorboat
Crabs	People eat crabs as sea food
Sand	Children play on sand
Cavity	There are cavities in beach

FILL IN THE BLANKS WITH WORDS THAT CONVEY THE CORRECT MEANING OF THE SENTENCES.

1) Tiny hatchlings fall _____ (pray / **prey**) to many predators.
2) Sea turtles live their _____ (hole / **whole**) life in the sea .
3) The turtles come ashore only during the _____ (**night** / knight).
4) The predators follow the _____ (sent / **scent**) of the turtles to eat their eggs.
5) The female turtles lay eggs and go back to the _____ (see / **sea**).

USE THE CLUES AND FILL IN THE CROSSWORD PUZZLE.

1) This word rhymes with seen. - **Scene**
2) This animal has two horns and a spotted coat. - **Deer**
3) This is a huge sea animal. - **Whale**
4) Sounds like hair - **Hare**
5) Shines brightly - **Sun**
6) Rhymes with load - **Road**

20. WHEN THE TREES WALKED

-RUSKIN BOND

One morning while I was sitting beside Grandfather on the veranda steps, I noticed the tendril of a creeping vine trailing nearby. As we sat there in the soft sunshine of a North Indian winter, I saw the tendril moving slowly towards Grandfather. Twenty minutes later, it had crossed the step and was touching his feet.



There is probably a scientific explanation for the plant's behaviour _ something to do with light and warmth perhaps _ but I liked to think it moved across the steps simply because it wanted to be near Grandfather.

One always felt like drawing close to him. Sometimes when I sat by myself beneath a tree, I would feel rather lonely but as soon as Grandfather joined me, the garden became a happy place. Grandfather had served many years in the Indian Forest Service and it was natural that he should know trees and like them.

On his retirement, he built a bungalow on the outskirts of Dehradun, planting trees all around _ lime, mango, orange and guava, also eucalyptus, jacaranda, and Persian lilacs. In the **fertile (able to produce a lot of plants or crops)** Doon Valley, plants and trees grew tall and strong. There were other trees in the compound before the house was built, including an old peepul that had forced its way through the walls of an **abandoned (left without care)** outhouse, knocking the bricks down with its **vigorous (healthy and strong)** growth. Peepul trees are great show offs.

Even when there is no breeze, their broad-chested, slim-waisted leaves will spin like tops determined to attract your attention and invite you into the shade.

Grandmother had wanted the peepul tree cut down but Grandfather had said, 'Let it be, we can always build another outhouse.'

- India has more than 17000 species of flowering plants.
- Tamil Nadu with more than 5000 species – nearly 1/3rd of the total flora of India - probably has the highest diversity in India.

Grandmother didn't mind trees, but she preferred growing flowers and was constantly ordering catalogues and seeds. Grandfather helped her out with the gardening not because he was crazy about flower gardens but because he liked watching butterflies and 'There's only one way to attract butterflies,' he said, 'and that is to grow flowers for them.'

1) When did the garden become a happy place for the author?

- The garden became a happy place for the author when his grandfather joined him.

2) What are the two reasons the author gives for the plants moving towards grandfather?

- The two reasons the author gives for the plants moving towards grandfather are,
  - ✓ Light & Warmth
  - ✓ They liked to be near grandpa.

3) Why does the writer think that the peepul tree is a great show off?

- Even when there is no breeze, their road-chested, slim waisted leave will spin like tops determined to attract your attention and invite you into the shade.

SECTION-II

READ THIS SECTION SILENTLY. UNDERLINE THE MOST IMPOR-TANT EVENTS OF THE STORY. DISCUSS WHAT YOU HAVE UNDE-RLINED WITH YOUR PARTNER. DID YOU UNDERLINE THE SAME SENTENCES? DISCUSS IN CLASS.

Grandfather wasn't content with growing trees in our compound. During the rains, he would walk into the jungle beyond the river-bed armed with cuttings and saplings which he would plant in the forest. 'But no one ever comes here!' I had **protested (opposed or disagreed)** , the first time we did this. 'Who's going to see them?' 'See, we're not planting them simply to improve the view,' replied Grandfather.



'We're planting them for the forest and for the animals and birds who live here and need more food and shelter.'

'Of course, men need trees too,' he added, 'To keep the desert away, to attract rain, to prevent the banks of rivers from being washed away, for fruit and flowers, leaf and seed. Yes, for timber too.

But men are cutting down trees without replacing them and if we don't plant a few trees ourselves, a time will come when the world will be one great desert.' The thought of a world without trees became a sort of **nightmare (a frightening dream)** to me and I helped Grandfather in his tree-planting with greater enthusiasm. And while we went about our work, he taught me a poem by George Morris:

"Woodman, spare that tree!
Touch not a single bough!
In youth it sheltered me,
And I'll protect it now."

'One day the trees will move again,' said Grandfather. 'They've been standing still for thousands of years but there was a time when they could walk about like people. Then along came an **interfering (stopping)** busybody who cast a spell over them, rooting them to one place. But they're always trying to move. See how they reach out with their arms!

And some of them, like the banyan tree with its travelling aerial roots, manage to get quite far.' We found an island, a small rocky island in a dry river-bed. It was one of those river-beds so common in the foothills, which are completely dry in summer but flooded during the monsoon rains.

- The Western Ghats is home to nearly 325 globally- threatened flora and fauna.

A small mango tree was growing on the island. 'If a small tree can grow here.' Said Grandfather, 'so can others.' As soon as the rains set in and while rivers could still be crossed, we set out with a number of tamarind, laburnum, and coral tree saplings and cuttings and spent the day planting them on the island.

1) Why do we need trees? List four reasons that Grandfather gives.

- We need trees to keep the desert away
- To attract rain.
- To prevent banks of rivers being washed away.
- For fruits and flowers
- For timber.

2) Why did the author help his grandfather plant trees?

- The thought of a world without trees became a sort of nightmare to the author and so he helped his grandfather in his tree-planting with greater enthusiasm.

3) What made Grandfather plant saplings on the rocky island?

- There was a mango tree on the island. So grandfather planted saplings there.

SECTION – III

TAKE TURNS AND READ THIS SECTION ALOUD. WORK IN PAIRS, DISCUSS, DESCRIBE AND LIST THE THREE MAIN EVENTS IN THIS SECTION.

The monsoon season was the time for **rambling** **(wandering)** about. At every turn, there was something new to see. Out of the earth and rock and leafless boughs, the magic touch of the rains had brought life and greenness. You could see the broad-leaved vines growing.

Plants sprang up in the most unlikely of places. A peepul would take root in the ceiling; a mango would **sprout** **(when seeds begin to grow into small plants)** on the window-sill. We did not like to remove them but they had to go if the house was to be kept from falling down. 'If you want to live in a tree, that's all right by me,' said Grandmother crossly.



'But I like having a roof over my head and I'm not going to have my roof brought down by the jungle.'

Then came the Second World War and I was sent away to a boarding school. During the holidays, I went to live with my father in Delhi. Meanwhile my grandparents sold the house and went to England.

Two or three years later, I too went to England and was away from India for several years. Some years later, I returned to Dehradun. After first visiting the old house – it hadn't changed much – I walked out of town towards the river-bed.

It was February. As I looked across the dry water-course, my eye was immediately caught by the **spectacular (eye-catching)** red blooms of the coral blossom. In contrast with the dry river-bed, the island was a small green paradise. When I went up to the trees, I noticed that some squirrels were living in them and a koel, a crow pheasant, challenged me with a mellow 'who-are-you, who-are-you.'

1) What did Grandmother feel about trees growing in the house?

- Grandmother felt that trees growing in the house made it look like a roof brought down by jungle.

2) Why did the author leave town?

- The author left town to live with his father.

3) How did Grandfather's dream come true?

- The island became a small green paradise.

4) Describe what the author saw when he went back to the island.

- When he went back to the island, the author noticed smaller trees, wild plants and grasses had sprung up under their protection. The trees they had planted long ago had multiplied.

But the trees seemed to know me; they whispered among themselves and **beckoned (to signal (someone) with your hand to ask the person to come closer or follow)** me nearer. And looking around I noticed that other smaller trees, wild plants and grasses had sprung up under their protection. Yes, the trees we had planted long ago had multiplied. They were walking again. In one small corner of the world, Grandfather's dream had come true.

- Ruskin Bond is an award winning Indian author of more than 500 books, short stories, essays and novels. He writes poetry and books for children as well as adults. He lives with his adopted family in Landour, in Mussoorie, India. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 1999 and Padma Bhushan in 2014.

SUMMARY

- The story is set in Dehradun, where the author lived with his grandparents. His grandfather planted a lot of trees in his house - lime, guava, orange etc., His grandmother was interested in flower gardens, that attracted a lot of butterflies.
- His grandfather planted trees also in the jungle beyond the riverbed. His grandfather had explained that birds, animals and humans need more trees in this world - we should replace every tree that we cut for our personal use; otherwise, the world will become a desert.
- They planted small trees in an island that is dry during summers and flooded during winters. Second World War started, and the author was sent away to a boarding school.
- He returned after several years to find that the small island looked like a lush green paradise - because of the trees they had planted had multiplied.
- He realized that his grandfather's dream of trees walking again had come true.

GLOSSARY	
WORDS	**MEANINGS**
fertile	able to produce a lot of plants or crops
abandoned	left without care
vigorous	healthy and strong
protested	opposed or disagreed
nightmare	a frightening dream
interfering	Stopping
rambling	wandering
sprout	when seeds begin to grow into small plants
spectacular	eye-catching
beckoned	to signal (someone) with your hand to ask the person to come closer or follow

TICK THE MOST APPROPRIATE OPTION.

1) According to the author the tendril was moving towards grandfather because it
   a. needed light and warmth.
   b. did not like the light and warmth.
   c. wanted to be near Grandfather.
   d. wanted to escape from the winter.
2) Grandmother had wanted the peepul tree cut down because
   a. she did not like trees.
   b. she wanted to grow flowers.
   c. it was an old tree.
   d. it was knocking down the bricks of the outhouse.
3) Grandfather helped grandma out with the gardening because he
   a. liked gardening.
   b. wanted to grow flowers to attract butterflies.
   c. wanted to beautify the garden.
   d. wanted to make the house green.
4) The author did not want to plant saplings in the forest because
   a. no one would come to see them.
   b. it was dangerous to enter the forest.
   c. it would not be of any use to them.
   d. no one would appreciate them.
5) Grandfather felt planting trees would help the forest because
   a. he wanted to make the view beautiful.
   b. the river-bed was dry.
   c. animals and birds in the forest would love him.
   d. the animals and birds would find it easier to live.
6) When the author returned from England to Dehradun, he found Grandfather's dream had come true because the
   a. old house had changed.
   b. river was full.
   c. trees had red flowers.
   d. forest covered the island.

READ THE STORY ON YOUR OWN. DISCUSS IN A GROUP AND COMPLETE THE STORY MAP BELOW.

A story map is the main events of the story given in a flow chart.

➢ Grandfather built a bungalow and **planted trees around it.**	➢ During the rains Grandfather walked into the jungle **and planted cuttings and saplings**
➢ During the second world war **the author was sent to a boarding school.**	➢ They found a small rocky island and Grandfather **planted a number of tamarind, laburnum and coral tree saplings.**
➢ Some years later, the author returned and **saw the Island.**	➢ He looked around and noticed **a beautiful small green paradise.**